

AI Roadmap — Open Questions (Quick Reference)

AI ROADMAP — OPEN QUESTIONS (QUICK REFERENCE)

INTERNAL — Strategic Insights working document. Not for distribution.

Parked items that inform the roadmap but stay out of the executive report. One line of context, one next step each.

1. **Self-service vs. service shop.** Do we train units to solve their own problems on friendly platforms (Azure/Databricks), or run a specialist shop that does it for them (e.g., Tesseract)? The answer drives hiring and tooling. *Next: make this an explicit decision point in the next roadmap iteration; document digitization is the pilot case.*
2. **MLOps hiring is a hard market.** Senior-rung, high-paying, competitive role; university pay may not reach. Mitigations: agentic MLOps tooling (Databricks), internal transfer/upskilling, or a phased junior-first hire. *Next: market + tooling scan before the job description is written.*
3. **OCR / digitization path.** New Tesseract techniques (state-agency precedent: ~100% on dense scans) may let us crunch the transcript backlog free of charge — which could also improve the AMP model. VLM OCR is better but costs tokens; some models are off-limits. *Next: validate on the hardest documents, then start the backlog.*
4. **Course/room optimizer.** Incumbent costs ~\$500K/yr and can't handle basic constraints; provost-level energy exists to build in-house. Hard problem at enterprise scale — target "better than the incumbent," not perfect. Low last-mile burden (output goes to the registrar). *Next: scoping session with the provost's office.*
5. **AI teammate architecture.** Open question: can the project expert run on direct chunks, or is a vector/distillation layer needed? Also: use the roadmap reporting workflow as the system's first test bed once deadlines allow. Email backlinks may not be stable — bound that effort. *Next: comparative retrieval tests.*
6. **Micro-credentialing placement.** Doesn't fit one bucket; fine. Don't lose the positioning: in-person instruction on industry-standard content, presidential sponsorship.
7. **Bucket 1 end-state.** Embedded AI point people in each unit, not a central help desk — design the training program (train-the-trainer) accordingly.
8. **Funding path.** Request routes to the president's level, not the CFO channel; move while attention is high. Mostly next-FY money, but small current-year funds could cover tooling/pilots.
9. **Watch list.** Vendor diversification for AI dev (Google/Anthropic/OpenAI talks — SI joins once formal); TAICCI compute cooperative (could change our compute economics); state DIR AI sandbox (quiet — check occasionally); route framework support through the new liaison.